CHAPTER 16

TEST DEBUT

22 May 2003

ENGLAND vs ZIMBABWE, 1st Test, *Lord's*

England 472; Zimbabwe 147 & 233 (following on)

England won by an innings and 92 runs

Zimbabwe first innings: **J Anderson 16–4–73–5**

Here I am, suddenly sitting in the England dressing room at Lord's, where I watched all those Lancashire fans run across the pitch. Then I was on the outside, now I am on the inside and selected to play in a Test match. Even though I have taken the first ever hat-trick in a one day game for England just a month before, it is all so surreal. I have walked the stairs, poked my head around the long room, ran my hands up the staircase, stared at the portraits of greats gone by, reached out and touched the surfaces as if to test if it is all as expensive as it looks, then waited until all the regulars have got in. It is still surreal in itself to attach actual human beings to the names I have been watching from television as a Burnley club cricketer only a year ago: Trescothick, Vaughan, Butcher, Hussain, Key, Stewart. The list goes on.

I am on debut with Anthony McGrath from Yorkshire, much older than me, his body language much more suited to this kind of thing. He looks like he has had a lifetime more than me to ready himself and yet both of us wait to find our spot, making sure we are not in anyone's territory. Eventually, I am just sitting in a corner, as still as I can be, trying to blend into the surroundings. It's not the easiest thing to do given my hair is bleached blond, and I can tell that my hair, contrasting against my near-mute